

STEELING THE SHOW

At Stainless Infraverse 2.0 by Jindal Stainless, experts highlighted stainless steel as the material of choice for India's growing infrastructure ambitions

Bureau Report





As India accelerates its urban expansion, a critical question emerges: are we building for today or the next century? Stainless Infraverse 2.0, organised by Jindal Stainless in Chennai, brought this question to the forefront..

The Longevity Challenge

Amid India's rapid infrastructure expansion, material choice is often treated as a technical afterthought, sidelining lifecycle performance and structural integrity.

Infrastructure failures caused by material degradation highlight the economic and social cost of short-sighted material choices. Industry estimates suggest India loses 3–4% of its GDP annually to corrosion. Structural failures are a stark reminder that material choice is inseparable from public safety.

Expert Dialogue

Moderated by Dr. S. Arul Jayachandran (IIT Madras), the panel brought together experts including Sridhar Vedula (Southern Railway), C. Balamurugan (PWD), Dr. Vijaya Vengadesh Kumar J (NITK Surathkal), Kosalraman CJ (Infrabees), and Prabhu Chandran (ES Structural Consultant). The panel noted that while stainless steel may involve higher upfront costs, its longer lifespan and lower maintenance make it a more economical and sustainable choice.

At the event, Mr Rajeev Garg, Head of Sales, Jindal Stainless, emphasised: "the decisions we make at the planning and sourcing stage will define the safety, lifecycle costs, and environmental impact for decades. Material choice is a nation-building responsibility, and stainless steel supports the nation's long-term interests."

A Multitalented Material

The conclave also showcased a wide-range of stainless steel applications ranging from bridges and architecture to interior spaces, demonstrating how one material can serve multiple roles owing to its corrosion resistance, strength and long lifecycle.

As India progresses towards becoming a manufacturing powerhouse, the true measure of progress isn't just how fast we construct, but how long our structures will stand.